

Gardening Contract Quote Comparison

Annual Grounds Maintenance Services — Woodland Road, Ivybridge

Contract Period: 1st April 2026 – 31st March 2027

PRICE COMPARISON

CONTRACTOR	COMPANY	PRICE (EX VAT)	VAT	PRICE (INC VAT)	MONTHLY PAYMENT
Jonathan Axten	Green Green Grass	£18,000.00	N/A (not registered)	£18,000.00	£1,500.00 / month
Kane Smith	Smith's Lawn & Home Maintenance	£27,000.00	N/A (not registered)	£27,000.00	£2,250.00 / month
Adrian Rainbird	Sound Site Services (SSS)	£24,000.00	£4,800.00	£28,800.00	£2,400.00 / month

QUOTE SUMMARIES & PROS / CONS

1. Jonathan Axten Green Green Grass

£18,000.00

Annual price: £18,000.00 (no VAT – not VAT registered) · Monthly instalments: £1,500.00

PROS

- ✓ **Lowest overall price** – most cost-effective option by a significant margin.
- ✓ **Not VAT registered** – price quoted is the total payable (no VAT surcharge).
- ✓ **Existing site knowledge** – previously carried out this work; familiar with the grounds.
- ✓ **Fully qualified groundsman** – confirmed able to undertake all required works.
- ✓ **All machinery included** – brings own equipment and will use client's ride-on mower.
- ✓ **Public liability insurance** – documentation available on request.
- ✓ **Flexible/surplus hours** – surplus time used for general maintenance as directed.
- ✓ **Simple, clear pricing** – fixed monthly payment, easy to budget.

CONS

- ✗ **Single operative** – illness, absence or emergency may impact maintenance schedule.
- ✗ **No formal company structure** – sole trader; less resilience if personal circumstances change.
- ✗ **Limited formal detail in tender** – brief submission, lacks structured experience breakdown.
- ✗ **Waste removal excluded** – client will need to arrange separate disposal.
- ✗ **Fuel excluded** – additional contractor cost which could affect attendance frequency.

2. Kane Smith Smith's Lawn & Home Maintenance

£27,000.00

Annual price: £27,000.00 (no VAT – not VAT registered) · Monthly invoicing: £2,250.00

PROS

- ✓ **Not VAT registered** – price quoted is the total payable (no VAT surcharge).
- ✓ **Detailed, professional tender** – thorough submission covering all required elements.
- ✓ **Fuel included** – unlike other quotes, fuel costs are absorbed by the contractor.
- ✓ **Qualified and experienced** – relevant commercial grounds maintenance background.
- ✓ **Public liability insurance** – documentation available on request.
- ✓ **Committed to making up lost time** – clearly addresses on-call firefighting absence risk.
- ✓ **References available on request.**

CONS

- ✗ **Highest fixed price** – at £27,000, this is £9,000 more than the lowest quote.
- ✗ **On-call firefighter** – may occasionally be called away for emergency duties at short notice.
- ✗ **Single operative** – same single-person resilience concern as the Axten quote.
- ✗ **Waste removal excluded** – unless agreed separately.
- ✗ **Herbicides/materials not included** – priced separately; potential additional cost.

3. Adrian Rainbird Sound Site Services (SSS)

£28,800.00 inc VAT

Annual price: £24,000.00 + VAT = £28,800.00 inc VAT · Monthly: £2,000.00 + VAT (£2,400.00 inc VAT)

PROS

- ✓ **Established commercial company** – manages ~200 commercial sites across the South West.
- ✓ **Award-winning contractor** – Housing 21 'Contractor of the Year' two consecutive years.
- ✓ **Two-person team** – improves H&S (no lone working), efficiency, and provides built-in cover.
- ✓ **Local company** – based just a couple of miles from the site; quick response times.
- ✓ **Broader service offering** – landscaping, groundworks, fencing, brickwork, pathways, patios.
- ✓ **Experienced, trained staff** – clearly resourced to deliver to specification.
- ✓ **Flexible and collaborative** – offers to help bring the whole site back to a high standard.

CONS

- ✗ **Highest overall cost** – at £28,800 inc VAT, this is the most expensive option.
- ✗ **Quote is informal** – submitted as an email; lacks formal confirmation of all tender elements.
- ✗ **Proposed staffing change** – shift from 1 person × 2 days to 2 people × 1 day needs client agreement.
- ✗ **VAT is a cost** – if the Trust cannot reclaim VAT, effective cost is significantly higher.
- ✗ **Waste removal not explicitly addressed** – terms should be clarified.

SUMMARY MATRIX

FACTOR	JONATHAN AXTEN	KANE SMITH	SSS / SOUND SITE SERVICES
Annual cost (inc VAT)	✓ £18,000	£27,000	✗ £28,800
Site knowledge	✓ Existing	✗ New	✗ New
Not VAT registered	✓	✓	✗
Staffing resilience	✗ Solo	✗ Solo	✓ 2-person team
Company size / track record	Small / solo	Small / solo	✓ Established (200 sites)
Award-winning	✗	✗	✓ Housing 21 COTY ×2
Fuel included	✗	✓	TBC
Tender completeness	Basic	✓ Detailed	Informal email
Broader services available	✗	✗	✓ Yes

RECOMMENDATION

Jonathan Axten (Green Green Grass) offers the most competitive price at £18,000 with no VAT and already knows the site, making him the lowest-risk, lowest-cost option if budget is the primary concern. However, reliance on a single individual carries operational risk.

Kane Smith (Smith's Lawn & Home Maintenance) provides a thorough and professional submission but is the most expensive single-contractor option and carries the additional risk of periodic absence due to on-call firefighting commitments.

Sound Site Services (SSS) is the highest-priced option but offers the strongest company credentials, a two-person team (improving health & safety), local presence, and the broadest capability for additional estate works. They are well-suited if a longer-term relationship with a commercial contractor is preferred.